

CHAPTER ONE: INTRODUCTION

UNIT DESCRIPTION

This chapter deals with the meaning of leadership, difference between leadership and management, the characteristics of effective leaders and the importance of leadership for good governance and development.

Learning outcomes

Upon the completion of this unit, students are required to:

- ✓ Define the term of leadership
- ✓ Difference between leadership and management
- ✓ Explain what makes effective leader
- ✓ Briefly explain the importance of leadership for good governance and development
- ✓ Understand the foundations for effective leadership

1. The concept of leadership and its definition

1.1. Concept of leadership

Until the Second World War, leadership was largely a mystical subject linked closely to class issue and social position. The study of leadership as a subject really developed in the 1940s in the wake of the Second World War, probably due to the demonstration of leadership by individuals coping with enormous responsibilities amidst the chaos of that worldwide conflict. It was also significant that the mastermind of the war, Adolf Hitler, held the title of the leader, the title the military and political leaders of that area. It was therefore hardly surprising that the first theory to emerge was that of the Great man theory or the quality approaches and we are not being politically incorrect by calling such theories Great Man rather than Great person.

For many people until the latter part of twentieth century, as we have already mentioned, leadership has been thought the concept which is primarily male, military and western. This of course is far from the truth. History has shown us female leaders of outstanding ability such as Indra Gandhi, Golda Meir, Margaret Thatcher, Anglia Miracle, Queen Sheeba,

Empress Tayitu, etc.

1.2. Definition of Leadership

What is leadership?

What does leadership mean to you? Every business owner and CEO wants to be a good leader, but how can you be a good leader if you don't know what leadership really is?

Unfortunately, leadership doesn't have a one-size-fits-all definition. We all have our own ideas about what it means to be a good leader. For example, some people think leadership means guiding others to complete a particular task, while others believe it means motivating the members of your team to be their best selves. But while the definitions may vary, the general sentiments remain the same: leaders are people who know how to achieve goals and inspire the people around them along the way.

Business News Daily asked 30 business owners and experts to define what leadership means to them. Their ideas may just lead you to create your own definition of leadership. Here's what they had to say:

"Leadership is having a vision, sharing that vision and inspiring others to support your vision while creating their own." (Gibbins)

"Leadership is the ability to guide others without force into a direction or decision that leaves them still feeling empowered and accomplished." (Cash)

"Effective leadership is providing the vision and motivation to a team so they work together toward the same goal, and then understanding the talents and temperaments of each individual and effectively motivating each person to contribute individually their best toward achieving the group goal." (Kimer)

"Leadership is being bold enough to have vision and humble enough to recognize achieving it will take the efforts of many people — people who are most fulfilled when they share their gifts and talents, rather than just work. Leaders create that culture, serve that greater good and let others soar." (Heasley)

"In my experience, leadership is about three things: To listen, to inspire and to empower. Over the years, I've tried to learn to do a much better job listening actively, making sure I really understand the other person's point of view, learning from them, and using that basis of trust and collaboration to inspire and empower. [It's about] setting the bar high, and then giving them the time and resources to do great work." (Garfield)

"I define leadership as knowing when to be in front to lead and guide a team during the journey, and when to step back and let others take the lead. Much like an athlete who knows exactly what position to move to on the field at any given time, a true business leader understands the delicate balance of how to help others become leaders, fuel career ambitions, then give them the chance to shine." (Schoenbaum)

"Leadership is the behavior that brings the future to the present, by envisioning the possible and persuading others to help you make it a reality." (Barney)

"Leadership styles differ, but at the core, good leaders make the people they are leading accomplish more than they otherwise would. The most effective leaders do this not through fear, intimidation or title, but rather by building consensus around a common goal." (Madine)

Though individuals define leadership differently based on their experience and perception, for simplicity purpose we can define leadership as;

- It is a process by which one person influences the thoughts, attitudes, and behaviors of others. Leaders set a direction for the rest of us; they help us see what lies ahead; they help us visualize what we might achieve; they encourage us and inspire us. Without leadership a group of human beings quickly degenerates into argument and conflict, because we see things in different ways and learn toward different solutions.
- Leadership helps to point us in the same direction and harness our efforts jointly. Leaders have unique ability to get other people to do something significant that might not otherwise do. Leading is establishing direction and influencing others to follow that direction. But this definition isn't as simple as it sounds because leadership has many variations and different areas of emphasis. Common to all definitions of leadership is the notion that leaders are individuals who, by their actions, facilitate the movement of a group of people toward a common or shared goal. This definition implies that leadership is a social influence process. The distinction between leader and leadership is important, but potentially confusing. The leader is an individual; leadership is the function or activity that this individual performs. The word leader is often used interchangeably with the word manager to describe those individuals in an organization who have positions of formal authority, regardless of how they actually act in those jobs.

But just because a manager is supposed to be a formal leader in an organization doesn't mean that he or she exercises leadership.

What Effective Leaders Do? The leadership function involves the following activities:

- ✓ Setting shared objectives for group
- ✓ Be able to motivate & direct others
- ✓ Take responsibility for the direction & actions of a team
- ✓ Organizing & motivating others.
- ✓ Taking the initiative
- ✓ Persevering when things are not working out.
- ✓ Taking a positive attitude to frustration/failure.
- ✓ Accepting responsibility for mistakes/wrong decisions.
- ✓ Being flexible: prepared to adapt goals in the light of changing situations

How to become a good leader-

- Use **initiative** to act on opportunities. Become a leader before other people view you as one. Healthy organizations reward those who take the lead, not just those with formal management roles.
- **Take responsibility** for own objectives: set priorities.
- Display a "**can do**" attitude even in demanding situations. Try to solve problems yourself rather than to pass them on to other people. First answer is 'yes, I'll make it happen'.
- "**Go the extra mile**" when asked to do tasks. Go beyond your job description. Do work that gets you noticed.
- **Show enthusiasm**: this will be noticed and you will eventually be rewarded.
- **Take ownership of problems**: anticipate potential problems, take pre-emptive action and act quickly to resolve problems.
- **Introduce improvements** to the way things are done.
- Develop **innovative** practices. Value innovative thinking.
- **Learn new skills** that will enhance capability.

1.3. Leadership versus Management

An issue often debated among business professionals is whether leadership is a different function and activity from management. A famous Harvard's scholar (Kotter) says that

- ☞ To manage means to bring about, to accomplish, to have charge of or responsibility for, and to

conduct.

- ☞ Leading is influencing, guiding in a direction, course, action, opinion.
- ☞ Management is about coping with complexity, and
- ☞ Leadership, in contrast, is about coping with change.
- ☞ He also states that leadership is an important part of management, but only a part;
- ☞ Whereas effective management requires planning, organizing, staffing, and controlling.
- ☞ Management produces a degree of predictability and order. Leadership produces change.
- ☞ Kotter believes that most organizations are under lead and over managed. He sees both strong leadership and strong management as necessary for optimal organizational effectiveness.
- ☞ Managers do things right; leaders do the right thing.

Leadership and management are both important, but they seek to do different things. About 40 years ago Lewin put it this way. Every organization structures itself to accomplish its goals in a way that is in tune with or responsive to its environment. Once the efficiency of the organization is established, people go about simply maintaining the system, assuming that the environment will stay the same. Management, then, is the main focus because it keeps the organization going well with little change. But the thing is: the environment for any organization is always changing. There are always shifts in consumer tastes, social attitudes, society's culture, technology, historic events, and so on. The world is not static as we assume. Organizations tend not to spot these changes quickly, often because of a "management orientation" which is focused more on "looking in" instead of "looking out". Over time, the organization can become less and less in tune with or responsive to its environment, creating more and more management problems. Times like this require organizations to think more in terms of leadership. Leaders begin to ask questions like, "What is really going on here? How do we become relevant again? How do we fulfill our goals in these new times? What will prompt people to think that what we do is meaningful?" Leaders seek to bring their organization more in line with the realities of their environment, which often necessitates changing the very structures, resources and relationships of their organization which they have worked so long and so hard to manage. And yet, as they do, leaders can bring renewed vitality to their people.

According to Kotter, leadership & Management functions differ on the following issues

	Leadership functions	Management functions
Creating agenda	Establishing direction vision, strategies for change	Plans and budget; decides action plans and timetable , allocate resources
Developing people	Aligning people; communicate vision and strategy , influence creation of teams towards goals	Organizing and staffing ; decide on procedure and monitoring structure, allocate staff , develop policy
execution	Motivating and inspiring	Controlling , problem solving Monitor result against plan and take corrective action
Outcomes	Produces positive and sometimes dramatic changes	Produces order; consistency and predictability

Generally, some of the fundamental differences between manager and leader are as follows;

- 🧩 The manager administers; the leader innovates.
- 🧩 The manager maintains; the leader develops.
- 🧩 The manager accepts reality; the leader investigates it.
- 🧩 The manager focuses on systems and structures; the leader focuses on people.
- 🧩 The manager relies on control; the leader inspires trust.
- 🧩 The manager has a short-range view; the leader has a long-range perspective.
- 🧩 The manager asks how and when; the leader asks what and why.
- 🧩 The manager has his or her eye always on the bottom line; the leader has his or her eye on the horizon.

- ✚ The manager imitates; the leader originates.
- ✚ The manager accepts the status quo; the leader challenges it.
- ✚ The manager is the classic good soldier; the leader is his or her own

1.4 What makes Effective Leadership?

As with most popular sayings, there is some truth in the proverb, “Great leaders are born, not made.”

To some extent, the capacity for great leadership is innate. However, learning how to be a more effective leader is within everyone’s grasp – whether you lead multiple teams, an entire company or just one staff member.

Effective leadership is the process of achieving desired result through people’s positive/willing participation. The empathy of this definition is *through people willing participation*. Surely, leadership is about achieving results, it will not suffice to create warm happy work place that goals bankrupt.

Some of the qualities and traits of great leaders that you can learn and practice:

- **Self-assessment:** - Effective leaders periodically take stock of their personal strengths and shortcomings. They ask: “What do I like to do? What am I really good at?” “What are my areas of weakness, and what do I dislike doing?” as a leader Knowing your areas of weakness does not make you weak; on the contrary, it allows you to delegate to others who have those abilities, in order to achieve the group’s common goal. Rather than sticking to the false belief that they can do it all, great leaders hire people who complement, rather than supplement, their skills. Working on your areas of weaknesses will improve your leadership ability – and recognizing them makes you more human and stronger.
- **Sharp perception:** - Do you know how people really perceive you? Effective leaders do. They have an easy level of honest communication with their teams and their peers, and a thorough understanding of how they are perceived. Testing others’ perception of you can be as simple as observing their behavior. Are your co-workers and team members relaxed around you? Does all conversation stop when you enter the room? If you really want to know what people think, just ask them. You may receive feedback that you’re not listening or showing appreciation as you could be. If you’ve established an environment of honest and open communication, you should be able to ask about your good qualities and the areas you need to improve on. Your staff will appreciate your effort.

- **Responsive to the group's needs:** - Being perceptive can also help a leader be more effective in knowing the needs of the team. Some team's value trust over creativity; others prefer a clear communicator to a great organizer. Building a strong team is easier when you know the values and goals of each individual, as well as what they need from you as their leader.
- **Knowing the organization:** - Effective leaders know the organization's overall purpose and goals, and the agreed-upon strategies to achieve these goals; they also know how their team fits into the big picture, and the part they play in helping the organization grow and flourish. Full knowledge of your organization – inside and out – is vital to becoming an effective leader.
- **Passion:** - An effective leader is a person with a passion for a cause that is larger than they are. Without passion, a leader will not make the necessary courageous and difficult decisions and carry them into action. This is not to imply that all decisions are of this nature. But you can be sure, some of them will be. The leader without a passion for a cause will duck.
- **Holder of Values:** - A leader must have values that are life-giving to society. It is the only kind of leadership we need. This then also implies values that are embedded in respect for others. So, often we think of people skills or caring about people as being “warm and fuzzy.” A leader can be of varying ‘warmth and fuzziness,’ but a leader has to respect others. You can't lead without it. Otherwise, we are back to manipulation. Respect means also that one can deal with diversity a critical need for a leader in today's world probably always has been, although diversity may have been more subtle in the homogenous societies of the past.
- **Vision:** - This is a bit different than passion, but in other ways it isn't separable. If one doesn't care about a subject, an issue, a system, and then one won't spend the time thinking about how it could or should be different. Yet, one could have strong feelings about something and not good ideas, particularly if she didn't spend a good deal of time studying the topic. Thus a leader has to have some ideas about change, about how the future could be different. Vision then is based on two components that leaders also need: creativity and intellectual drive.
- **Creativity:** - One has to try to think out of the box to have good visions and to come up with effective strategies that will help advance the vision. The need for a sense of humor, it's a creative skill that is in great need by leaders.
- **Intellectual Drive and Knowledge:** - A leader has to be a student. In general it is hard for a

leader to be around enough other leaders to pick this up just through discussion. A leader has to be a reader and a learner.

- **Confidence and Humility Combined:** - While one can have a great vision and good ideas for change, and even passion for it, if one isn't confident, then action will not occur. Without action, there is no change. Yet, paradoxically, a leader needs to have humility. No matter how creative and bright one is, often the best ideas and thinking are going to come from someone else. A leader needs to be able to identify that, have good people around who have these ideas. This takes humility, or at least lack of egocentricity. The leader is focused on the ends and doesn't have to see herself always as the conduit or creator of the strategy to get to that end.
- **Communicator:** - None of the above assets will work for a leader if she/he can't speak or write in a way to convince others that they should follow along, join the team, and get on board. All the above gets to the old proverb that a leader knows how to do the right thing and a manager knows how to do things right. But a leader has to be a manager, too.
- **Planner/Organizer:** - Someone who can see what needs to be done and help the team plan and organize to get it done. Management is getting things done through people. While a writer or other visionary person may be very influential, even seminal for the cause of change, this is not quite my definition of a leader. A leader means to me, someone who is taking action, trying to get others to do something they want to see done.
- **Interpersonal Skills:** - Leaders must have the ability to act in an interpersonally competent manner, yet they also need to learn the techniques of good listening, honest and open communication, delegating, conflict resolution skills, etc., to actually get work done and keep the whole movement/organization/project together.

1.5 The Importance of Leadership in Good Governance and Development

A leader is no different from an ordinary person; the only thing that separates them from the pack is added responsibility. In every sphere of life, be it as small as a classroom or as large as a country, one person has to take charge to lead their peers. A leader is vital to give direction to a cause, help a group stay focused on the task at hand, and keep them motivated.

Any person can assume that responsibility, but not every person has the skills to fulfill that responsibility effectively. Taking responsibility for representing the interests of a whole corporate sector or taking charge of a governing body is one with high stakes involved and not one for the ill-equipped. Every leadership skill is crucial in the art of governance, and today we'll see how every little thing makes a significant impact in your role as a leader.

Patience

As mentioned before, governance is not a job for the faint-hearted, and as a leader of such a large population, there will always be opposition to your stance. It takes a composed leader to stop and hear out the concerns and different perspectives. It can significantly reduce bias, help come to a favorable solution for all concerned members, and at the end of the day, governance is all about catering to the needs of all.

Educate

A leader sets examples for people by what they do and what they say. To inspire reasonable steps in the right direction, a leader must know how to educate and convey their message to the masses effectively. A [Masters in educational leadership online](#) program is the perfect solution to understand model leadership and inspire the next generation in the right direction. This knowledge can also help form a long-term solution for reforming education and development. Not only will this form a society of more responsible citizens, but it will also ensure that the cradle of leadership falls into responsible hands in the future.

Empathy

Governance means that you are bound to meet people with all sorts of perspectives and beliefs. A strong leader is empathetic, one who can see and understand the world through the lenses of their subjects.

This quality helps understand the problems that communities under your responsibility are facing, and it serves as an effective tool to come up with practical solutions to cater to all. In the

art of governance, it humanizes the minorities, and it helps you protect their rights and keep them together with the greater society to progress.

Team-Building

Leadership is all about teamwork and team building, and when governing a large corporate body, or a whole country for that matter, it is essential to work with a group. It is crucial to have good coordination with your team; as a team, without any communication, we cannot effectively achieve a common goal.

Leadership is the bridge that makes this all possible, and it encourages greater transparency. Knowing your team and understanding their strengths help you make task delegation seamless, and better communication means good bonding and conflict resolution.

Integrity

Governance is a responsibility involving very high stakes, and dishonesty is unacceptable at such a high level. Leadership is essentially great integrity, and it means sticking to your core values and ethics.

It means keeping the moral high ground and keeping your trade honest. It sends a positive message to your subordinates, and in the long run, it also cements your reputation when you practice fair trade.

As a member of the government, nothing can go on without this quality. The development will go back many years if dealings are dishonest, such as public funds. It will lessen the trust of stakeholders, and in the long run, nobody will trust you in high positions if you cannot be a leader. There are many examples of third-world countries where dishonest officials misappropriate public funds and set back the country's development by many years.

Decisiveness

In the process of governance, many difficult decisions do come your way. A good leader has the quality of decisiveness. After taking in all inputs and having all the necessary information on the situation, a leader can come to a solution, decide, and then stand firmly by it.

This is because leaders are good communicators and inform themselves by listening to relevant perspectives. They listen to the concerns of all stakeholders in any situation before coming to a decision. When governing a large population, this is a handy skill to have. One recent example of good leadership is of New Zealand's Prime Minister. With the help of her medical team and

economic experts, she was able to take adequate measures against the pandemic in her country and bring it under control. Due to her leadership, the world now lauds New Zealand's situation.

Conclusion

Leadership encompasses all these qualities; honesty, patience, teamwork, decisiveness, and empathy. Governance is a responsibility where these leadership qualities are vital to maintaining that well-oiled machinery, with every part in the coordination of the other. Without these, any company or country is most certainly doomed to fail.